Phase 1b: Information and tasks

Status

Today is the 2nd of November. The outbreak of the new measles variant has continued to grow and it is now clear that public health institutes require a proper planning scenario to assess how bad this outbreak might become.

To assess the degree of under-reporting of cases in Denden, an enhanced contact tracing has been performed on the first notified 30 cases. All identified contacts were followed up for 2 weeks after exposure and tested regardless of symptoms. This contact tracing revealed additional cases compared to those discovered by routine surveillance, indicating that cases are under-reported in the line lists.

Information and Data

A new linelist, up-to-date as of the 1st of November and the results of the contact tracing has been made available. The contact list only includes the **contacts testing positive** and includes information about whether they were symptomatic. It also includes a column indicating if each positive contact had been detected through the normal surveillance routines used for the line-list dated 25th of October. If the case had already been discovered, the notified_case_id column will include the corresponding case_id used in the line-list.

Variable	Type	Description
contact_id	char	ID contact racing
index_case_id	char	Identifier of index case (exists in linelist)
setting	char	Type of contact: Household, work, school etc
age	integer	Age in years
vaccination_status	char	Vaccination status: unvaccinated, 2 doses, not offered (born to early)
symptoms	char	Did the contact have symptoms: yes/no
symptom_onset_date	date	Date of symptom start
hospitalized	char	Did the contact become hospitalised
notified_case_id	char	Case id as specified in the line list

All data for this exercise can be found at:
https://github.com/Gulfa/modelling_prep_ex/tree/main/exercise_data

Tasks

Create a planning scenario for the coming 6 months for your country, In a planning scenario, public health authorities want to understand the most likely trajectory and the reasonable best and worst case. The primary interest is to understand needs in the health care sector, especially hospitalizations and measure of overall burden of infections and deaths.

The modelling team has been requested to present their planning scenarios at 17:40 in a short presentation of maximum 5 min. With the short time-frame, it is up to each team to prioritize what should be included in the presentation. The target audience are public health officials from the public health authority.